MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
FIRST SEMESTER MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR

EXAMINATION March 2026

Fourth Semester

Title of the Course
Social History of Early Indian Art and Architecture
Course Code MG4SECHIS201
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 1.5 Hours Maximum Marks: 50

Remember (K), Understand (U), Apply (A), Analyse (An), Evaluate (E), Create (C), Interest (I),

Appreciation (Ap), and Skill (S)

Students should attempt atleast one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall

outcome attainability.

[Learning Domain][CO No(s)]

Part A
Multiple Choice Questions 10 out 12 NA 10 x 1 = 10

1. In early temple architecture, what is the name of the "womb-chamber" where the main deity is placed? . [U] [1]

a). Shikhara b). Garbhagriha

c). Amalaka d). Antarala

2. What is the name for the ceremonial gateways found at the four cardinal points of a Stupa . [U] [1]

a). Vimana b). Torana

c). Kalasha d). Jagati

3. what material was primarily used for Indian architecture before the widespread transition to stone during the Mauryan and Post-Mauryan periods . [U] [1]

a). Iron b). Marble

c). Wood d). Granite

4. The famous "Dancing Girl" figurine belongs to which civilization . [U] [1]

a). Vedic b). Mauryan

c). Indus d). Gupta

5. The 'Lion Capital' at Sarnath was commissioned by which Emperor. [U] [1]

a). Chandragupta b). Kanishka

c). Ashoka d). Harsha

6. What is the specific name for a Buddhist prayer hall? . [U] [1]

a). Mandapa b). Chaitya

c). Vimana d). Garbhagriha

7. Which dynasty saw the birth of the earliest structural Hindu temples, such as at Deogarh. [U] [1]

a). Kushan b). Gupta

c). Chola d). Maurya

8. In Dravidian architecture, what is the term for the monumental entrance tower. [U] [1]

a). Gopuram b). Vimana

c). Kalasha d). Jagat

9. The monolithic Kailashnath Temple at Ellora was built by which dynasty. [U] [1]

a). Pallava b). Rashtrakuta

c). Chalukya d). Satavahana

10. The "Gandhara" school of art shows the social influence of which foreign culture on Indian imagery. [U] [1]

a). Persian b). Chinese

c). Greek d). Egyptian

11. The "Shilpashastras" were technical treatises for which social group . [U] [1]

a). Farmers b). Artisans

c). Kings d). Traders

12. Which dynasty first used stone inscriptions and pillars to communicate social and ethical codes (Dhamma) to the public . [U] [1]

a). Gupta b). Kushana

c). Mauryan d). Chola

Part B
Short Answer Questions 5 out of 8 50 words 5 x 3 = 15
Answer any 5 questions.
Each question carries 3 marks

13	Write on the Town planning of indus valley civilization	[An] [1]
14	Discuss about the silent features of Harappa art	[A] [1]
15	Examine nagara style of Architecture	[K] [1]
16	Write on the features of Deograh temple	[K] [1]
17	Discuss about Konark sun temple	[U] [1, 3]
18	Who were the Yakshis, and what did they represent regarding the female form in early art?	[K] [3]
19	What does the "Dancing Girl" of Mohenjo-Daro suggest about female roles in the Indus Valley Civilization?	[U] [3]
20	Wrote about mother goddess	[K] [4]

Part C
Short Essay Questions 3 out of 6 120 words 3 x 5 = 15
Answer 3questions.
Each question carries 5 marks

21 Explain the importance of archaeology in understanding ancient art.An] [1]

22 Describe different archaeological methods used in the study of art history.
[An] [1]

23 Discuss the features and themes of prehistoric rock paintings in India. [U] [1]

24 Analyse the significance of prehistoric art as a cultural source.
[An] [3]

25 What is the historical significance of atrefacts? [U] [2]

26How is GIS utilized to study and interpret history? [U] [3]

Part D
Essay Question 1 out of 3 250 words 1 x 10 = 10 Total 50
Answer1questions.
Each question carries 10 marks

27 Examine various style of Temple Architecture
[S] [1]

28 How did monumental structures serve as tools for political legitimacy and the projection of power?

[U] [3]

29 Describe the materials and techniques used by prehistoric artists in India
[U] [3]

END OF THE QUESTION PAPER